

PRE-SEED · \$1M · 2026

The Crypto Lending Platform That *Explains Itself.*

Crypto-collateralized lending infrastructure for credit unions — with
AI-powered underwriting guidance built in. Pre-Seed · \$1M · 2026

140M

CU MEMBERS IN THE US

\$2.2T

CU ASSETS UNDER MANAGEMENT

\$0

B2B CRYPTO LENDING INFRASTRUCTURE

SCROLL

01 · PROBLEM

Credit unions are *locked out* of crypto lending.

140 million Americans trust their credit union over any bank. But when those members want to unlock liquidity from their Bitcoin or Ethereum holdings, they're forced to go to D2C lenders like Nexo or Ledn — or sell, triggering a taxable event.

Credit unions want to serve these members. The regulatory complexity is the barrier — not the appetite.

01 No compliant crypto lending infrastructure exists for NCUA-regulated institutions

02 D2C competitors (Nexo, Ledn, SALT) aren't B2B — they compete with CUs, not serve them

03 Younger members with crypto assets are migrating to fintech — CUs are losing them

04 No risk assessment model purpose-built for crypto collateral under NCUA guidelines exists

05 Custody, bank connectivity, and KYC/AML integration requires months of compliance work per institution

02 · SOLUTION

The *full stack* a credit union needs to go live.

Every competitor is building faster pipes. Aetherum builds the explanation layer — the first crypto lending platform that tells a member why they can borrow what they can borrow, automatically, at the point of decision.

01 · Lending Engine

Crypto-Collateralized Loans

Members keep their BTC/ETH exposure, avoid the taxable sale, and receive USD liquidity at 8–12% APR. Real-time LTV monitoring with automated margin calls.

02 · Risk

DACS™ Risk Assessment

Dynamic Asset Credit Scoring — a patent-pending ten-pillar risk model purpose-built for crypto collateral. AI-powered guidance layer live — members receive plain-language borrowing insights directly from their DACS profile.

PATENT PENDING

03 · Custody

Institutional Custody

Each credit union holds its own direct institutional custody account. Member wallets live within the CU's structure. Aetherum is the software layer only — we never touch member assets.

04 · Compliance

Compliance Infrastructure

Bank-grade financial data connectivity approved and live across 6 core products. KYC/AML and fraud infrastructure MSA fully executed — production-ready compliance infrastructure live. Annual billing secured, consortium anonymization in contract.

05 · Compliance

ERC-3643 On-Chain Identity

Clean-room implementation of three ERC-3643 compliance modules — jurisdiction gating, collateral LTV verification, and CU member identity attestation. Built on the T-REX standard. Deployed on Sepolia testnet.

PATENT PENDING

06 · Privacy

Privacy-Preserving Underwriting (FHE-DACS)

Member financial data is encrypted before the risk assessment process begins. Lending decisions are computed without exposing raw inputs at any step — ever. Patent-pending architecture purpose-built for NCUA-regulated institutions.

PATENT PENDING

07 · Yield

Staking Module

Members can stake supported digital assets directly through the platform — earning yield while maintaining collateral eligibility for crypto-backed loans. Adds a yield layer to the Aetherum product suite, deepening member engagement and creating an additional revenue stream for credit union partners. Coming Soon.

08 · Tax Intelligence

Tax-Position Score & Collateral Optimizer (TPSOE™)

The TPSOE engine scores the tax efficiency of every collateral position in a member's portfolio — ranking assets by embedded tax liability so the optimal pledge set is always selected. Members borrow smarter, not just more: no taxable event, no unnecessary capital gains exposure. The Collateral Optimizer computes UGLV and TAEV per asset, selects the lowest tax-cost collateral set that satisfies LTV requirements, and surfaces estimated tax savings to the member. Patent-pending sixth DACS pillar. No B2B competitor offers this to institutions.

PATENT PENDING

09 · Member Intelligence

Member Crypto Insights

Real-time visibility into the digital assets your members already own — before they need a loan. Consent-based wallet connections, DACS eligibility scoring, and an opt-in loan pipeline that surfaces qualified borrowers before they apply. The first CU intelligence layer built for the digital asset era.

PATENT PENDING

10 · Collateral Surveillance

Collateral Intelligence Engine (CIE™)

Every collateral position monitored 24/7. Finality-aware on-chain event processing, live LTV computation in basis points, DACS score updated on every price movement, and institution-authorized liquidation control — all automated. The always-on layer that makes crypto collateral operationally viable for credit union loan officers.

PATENT PENDING

11 · Regulatory

NCUA Examiner View

Read-only audit dashboard scoped per credit union. Live on-chain collateral positions, LTV ratios, liquidation events, and full BSA/AML audit trail. Built for NCUA examination from day one.

12 · Settlement

Programmable Stablecoin Wallets

Embedded wallet infrastructure for programmable stablecoin disbursement wired end-to-end into the loan origination and settlement pipeline. USDC collateral flows, cross-chain transfer protocol, and programmatic wallet provisioning live in production — enabling stablecoin-denominated disbursement and cross-chain settlement without exposing credit unions to custodial complexity.

LIVE IN PRODUCTION

— 03 · MARKET OPPORTUNITY

The *largest untapped* lending opportunity
in credit union history.

"Credit unions are sitting on the largest untapped lending opportunity in their history. Aetherum is the infrastructure layer that makes it accessible."

TAM · TOTAL ADDRESSABLE MARKET

\$150B+

Untapped Crypto Lending Gap

56M Americans hold crypto. Less than 1% can borrow against it through a regulated institution. That's a \$150B+ untapped lending gap — with no compliant path to liquidity today.

SAM · SERVICEABLE ADDRESSABLE MARKET

\$15–25B

NCUA-Regulated Credit Unions

4,800 NCUA-regulated credit unions. 140M members. An estimated 21M hold crypto today — with no compliant path to liquidity through their trusted financial institution.

SOM · SERVICEABLE OBTAINABLE MARKET

\$1.2M → \$36M ARR

3-Year Ramp

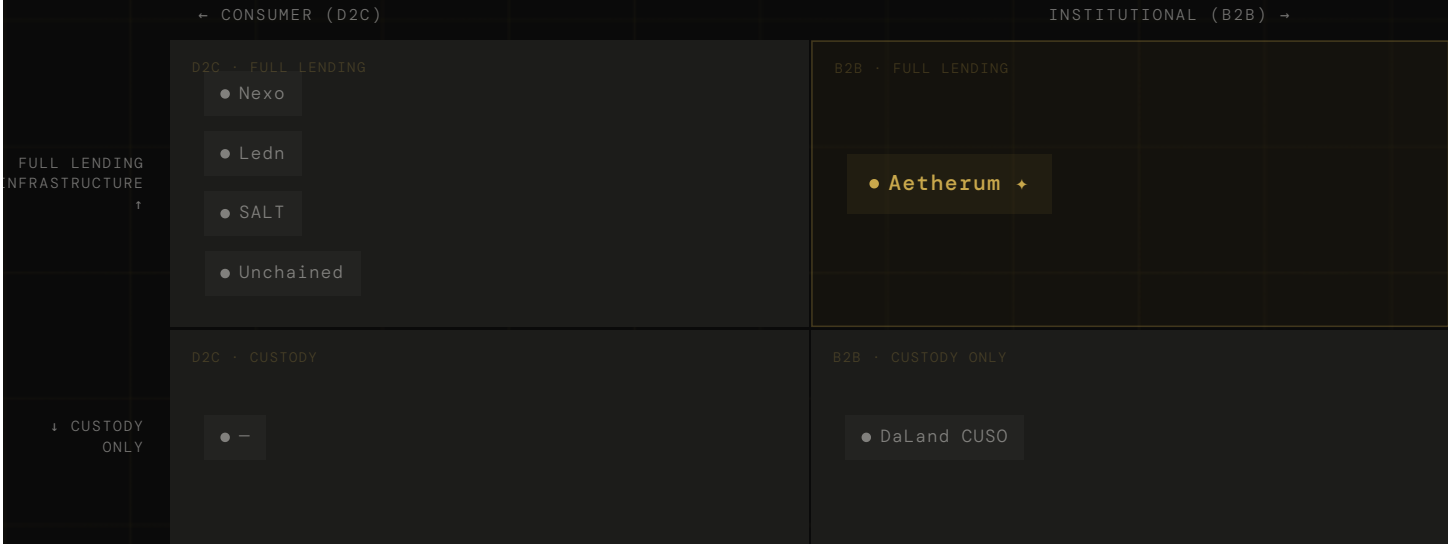
Year 1: 10 CUs × 100 loans/mo = \$1.2M ARR

Year 2: 50 CUs × 150 loans/mo = \$9M ARR

Year 3: 150 CUs × 200 loans/mo = \$36M ARR

04 · COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

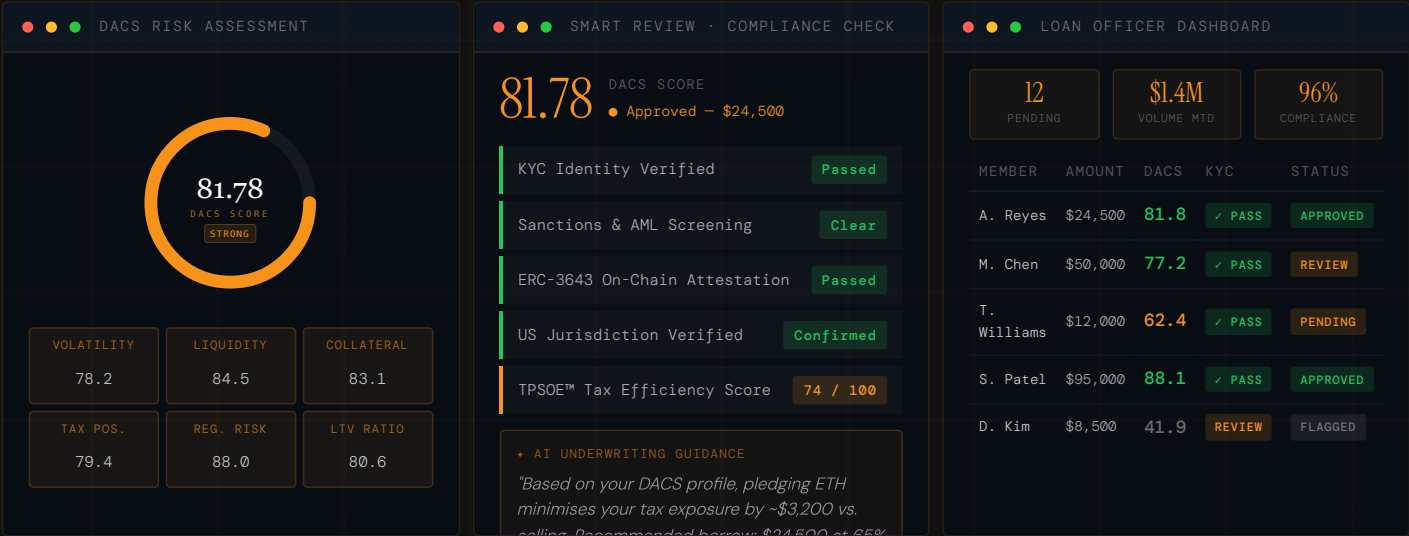
Built for institutions.
No one else is.



"Every competitor is building faster pipes. Aetherum is building the first crypto lending platform purpose-built for regulated institutions — with the compliance infrastructure to match."

05 · PLATFORM IN ACTION

Most fintech shows you a dashboard.
Aetherum shows you the reasoning.



DACS™ RISK GAUGE
Member sees their risk profile in real time — not just a number.

SMART REVIEW™
Every loan comes with an explanation the member can actually read.

LOAN OFFICER PORTAL
The CU sees everything their examiner wants to see.

06 · TRACTION

Built to the *compliance bar* that keeps others out.

BANK CONNECTIVITY

Financial data connectivity (CRA bundle) approved and live

— 6 core products active. Production approval used as investor data room leverage.

COMPLIANCE LAYER

KYC/AML & fraud integration— Executed MSA with production-ready compliance infrastructure. Annual billing. Live.

3 CORE SYSTEMS

Jack Henry FIN contract executed. Banno plugin live in Garden sandbox. Corelation KeyStone integration built and demo-ready. Fiserv AppMarket listing in progress.

LIQUIDATION LAYER

Three-tier liquidation escalation — human oversight for every large position

— Tier 1 auto-executes, Tier 2 pages risk officer with 30-min override window, Tier 3 requires explicit loan officer authorization. Twilio SMS + SendGrid alerts, loan officer dashboard actions, full audit trail. Built May 26, 2026.

LIVE

STABLECOIN SETTLEMENT

Stablecoin Settlement Infrastructure — live in production

— Three-layer settlement stack operational: USDC Collateral Flows, Cross-Chain Transfer Protocol, and Programmable Wallet Infrastructure — live in production.

LIVE

ARC TESTNET

CollateralEscrowTimelock deployed to Arc Testnet (Circle Layer-1, Chain ID: 5042002) — USDC native gas token. Mainnet Q3 2026.

0x1fF9a4c2...8897

LIVE

CUSTODY

Enterprise custody — live

— Each CU holds its own direct account — Aetherum never touches assets. Non-custodial by architecture.

MEMBER CRYPTO INSIGHTS

New intelligence layer

— Real-time visibility into member-owned digital assets — consent-based, examiner-ready, and patent pending.

DACS™

Ten-pillar risk model, live gauge wired to API. Includes TPSOE as sixth pillar, CUMember as seventh, FHE-DACS as eighth, DACS-LTV as ninth, and XRPL-COLLATERAL™ as sixth provisional.

PATENT
PENDING

TPSOE™

Tax-Position Score & Collateral Optimizer ranks pledge assets by embedded tax liability. No B2B competitor offers this to institutions.

PATENT
PENDING

FHE-DACS

Homomorphic encryption layer for DACS risk assessment. Member financial data remains encrypted throughout the entire underwriting decisioning process.

PATENT
PENDING

DACS-LTV™

Automated on-chain collateral LTV attestation triggered by DACS scoring. Collateral value and loan balance set directly on the AetherumCollateralLTVModule in real time.

PATENT
PENDING

XRPL-COLLATERAL™

XLS-66 LoanBroker integration architecture for NCUA-regulated credit unions. Covers: DACS-gated LoanBroker provisioning, Broker-Initiated Dual-Signature Flow (BIDSF) for compliant LoanSet transaction authorization, First-Loss Capital management as a regulatory capital analog, GENIUS Act Freeze/Deep Freeze compliance controls mapping, and XLS-70 member credential integration with CIP recordkeeping timestamps. Live demo running on XRPL testnet.

PATENT
PENDING

ECOSYSTEM ADVISOR

Steve Salzer, SVP at Velera —
Board Advisor to Aetherum.

Chairs the Board of Ongoing Operations LLC and sits on the NACUSO Regulatory Advocacy Committee and CUNA Payments Subcommittee.

SMART REVIEW

Shipped — live — AI-powered underwriting guidance live in production, zero additional friction in the loan flow.
in production Members receive a plain-language borrowing assessment automatically at the point of decision.

RIPPLE / XRPL

XLS-66 LoanBroker — Live integration running on XRPL testnet — LoanBrokerSet provisioning, dual-signature LoanSet flow (BIDSF), and First-Loss Capital health monitor all operational. Ripple BD relationship active — XLS-66 Design Partner designation in negotiation. RLUSD as native loan currency.

LIVE ON
TESTNET

CIE™

Collateral Intelligence Engine — Real-time collateral surveillance pipeline live in production. Custody webhook → LTV computation → DACS score update → risk state transition → audit log. 5-minute price monitor scheduler watching all active positions. 3 database schemas, 6 REST endpoints, live shipped todayLoan Officer Dashboard panel.

PATENT
PENDING

PLATFORM

MVP — Full-stack platform live at test-app.aetherum.ai — NestJS backend, React frontend, Python microservices, cloud Live database and cache across 6 cloud services. ERC-3643 compliance modules deployed on Sepolia.

ERC-3643

Clean-room implementation of three on-chain compliance modules — deployed on Sepolia testnet. Patent-pending CUMember identity attestation built on the T-REX standard. Live on-chain compliance attestation via ERC-3643 — deployed to Sepolia testnet.

PATENT
PENDING

JACK HENRY FIN

Contract executed. Banno plugin live in Jack Henry Garden sandbox. Production provisioning in progress. Core banking distribution layer serving 900+ credit unions.

CORELATION KEYBRIDGE

Certified integration — Corelation KeyBridge KeyStone core banking API integration live. ~290 credit unions on — live KeyStone reachable from day one.

RLUSD · RIPPLE

Supported collateral asset — XRPL — RLUSD added as a supported collateral asset. Expands the addressable integration live borrower base to XRP Ledger holders.

PHAROS

Pharos Network · Atlantic — Live integration with Pharos Atlantic Testnet. USDC contract wired, wallet generation, Testnet · USDC + CCTP Live balance checker, and USDC disbursement demo powered by Circle CCTP.

PHAROS · SPEED

Pharos Atlantic Testnet — USDC integration deployed same day as Circle's Pharos announcement — Demonstrates Aetherum's ability to integrate emerging settlement infrastructure as it launches. Zero lag from announcement to live demo.

ARC · CIRCLE

AetherumCollateralEscrow— ERC-20 collateral escrow token deployed to Circle's Arc Testnet (May 23, 2026). (ACE) — Arc Testnet — Contract: 0xf7dff33870fafb6a453c1a43b0bd4d89d001a9ed. Demonstrates live COMPLETE readiness on Circle's Layer-1 settlement infrastructure.

 [ArcScan](#)

T-REX / ERC-3643

Only on-chain compliance layer purpose-built for credit union lending.

07 · REVENUE MODEL

Five streams. *Platform-fee led.*

Revenue is tied directly to loan volume — meaning we grow as our credit union partners grow. The SaaS license layer adds predictable recurring revenue at scale.

$$\$1\text{K/loan} \times 100 \text{ loans/mo} \times 10 \text{ CUs} = \$1.2\text{M ARR}$$

ARR TARGET

Tax Intelligence add-on layer creates additional recurring revenue per CU partner.
ERC-3643 module licensing creates a second revenue surface independent of loan volume.

70%

Platform Fees

\$500–\$1,500 per loan originated. Primary revenue driver tied to volume.

20%

Transaction Fees

0.5–1% on crypto collateral transactions processed through the platform.

10%

SaaS License

\$50K–\$150K/year for large credit unions. Predictable ARR layer at scale.

New

Tax Intelligence Module

\$10K–25K/year per credit union as a premium add-on. Tells members not just what they can borrow — but which assets to pledge and how much they save in taxes by borrowing instead of selling. No B2B competitor offers this to institutions.

New

ERC-3643 Compliance Layer

Per-attestation module licensing fees. Any RWA issuer requiring US jurisdiction, collateral LTV gating, or CU member identity verification licenses Aetherum's compliance modules.

08 • TEAM & ADVISORS

Built by operators.
Advised by the ecosystem.

John Bailey

FOUNDER & CEO

20+ years in technical recruiting with placements at Google, Spotify, and Goldman Sachs. Previously co-founded Thorium Data (Data Catalog). Building Aetherum full-time since early 2025, managing all product, BD, fundraising, and technical implementation.

Steve Salzer

BOARD ADVISOR • SVP, VELERA

SVP at Velera since 2017. Chairs the Board of Managers at Ongoing Operations LLC. Sits on the NACUSO Regulatory Advocacy Committee and CUNA Payments Subcommittee. JD, University of Chicago Law School.

Rahul Goel

ADVISOR · JP MORGAN / UBER

Cybersecurity and financial infrastructure expertise from senior roles at JP Morgan and Uber, including involvement with Meta's Novi digital wallet. Advises on platform security architecture and institutional trust.

Saiprasad Raut

ADVISOR · WORLDPAY / VANAR

Head of Payments Infrastructure at Vanar, formerly Worldpay. Deep payments and blockchain infrastructure expertise guiding Aetherum's settlement and custody architecture.

09 · THE ASK

Closing a *\$1M Pre-Seed* Round.

We're in the final stretch of closing our pre-seed round. Proceeds go toward closing the first two credit union pilots, completing platform development, and bringing on a CTO.

Capital deploys us to first 3 credit union pilots — reducing market risk and proving the explanation layer at scale.

ROUND SIZE	\$1,000,000
INSTRUMENT	Post-Money SAFE
VALUATION CAP	\$8M Post-Money

DISCOUNT

20%

TIMELINE

Closing Soon

REQUEST A DEMO

Let's talk.

20 minutes. We'll walk through the platform live and answer any diligence questions.

BOOK A CALL

jbailey@aetherum.ai · aetherum.ai

